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DEVELOPING A HEALTH AND PREDICTIVE MAINTENANCE SYSTEM FOR ELECTRIC MOTORS

Predictive Maintenance via Real-Time Sensor Fusion

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PRESENTATION HIGHLIGHTS

FOCUS AREAS

- Motivation
- Project goal
- overview of the system
- IoT node
- Communication protocol
- API and Framework
- Demonstration of IoT Node
- Data collected from the IoT node
- Machine Learning
- Challenges & Advantages
- Proposed future work
- Conclusion

MOTIVATION: WHY MOTOR HEALTH MONITORING?

44%

of unplanned downtime
caused by equipment
failure

- Electric motors = the most widely used industrial equipment
- Failures cause production stoppages & major costs
- Traditional preventive maintenance = unnecessary downtime
- Industry 4.0: IoT + ML enables condition-based predictive maintenance

REACTIVE

Repair after
failure

PREVENTIVE

Scheduled
service

PREDICTIVE ✓

Condition-
based IoT

Typical
Downtime per
unexpected
failure

42-75 Hours

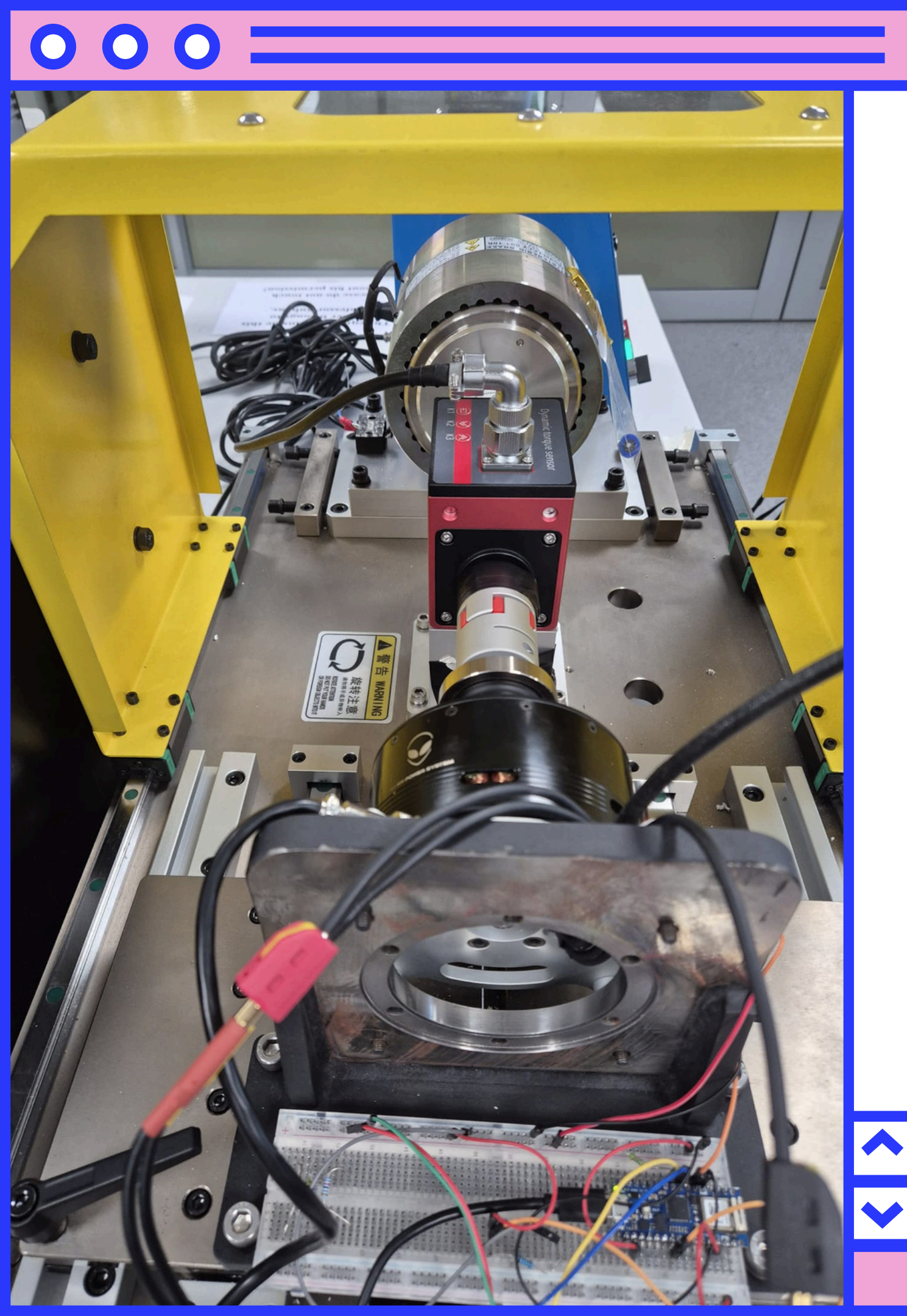
Cost rate
during
unplanned
shutdown

**\$10k -
\$50k/H**

Combined cost
per incident

**Up to
\$3.75 M**

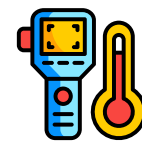
**IMPACT ON UNPLANNED
SHUTDOWN**



IOT: THE HERE AND NOW

AVAILABLE TECHNOLOGY

SENSOR INTERFACE



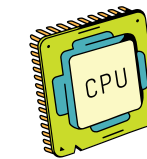
SHT11 - Digital (2-wire
serial) - Temperature



Shunt Resistor - Analog
- Current



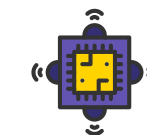
A3144 Hall - Digital -
RPM



SAMD21 Cortex®-M0+
32bit low power ARM MCU



Nina W102 uBlox module



LSM6DS3 onboard accel. -
I2C - Vibration

HOW DO WE COMMUNICATE?

INCREASED CONNECTIVITY LEADS TO HIGHER-LEVEL SOLUTIONS

The IoT Simplified

Communication Protocol and Data flow

WiFi Chosen Because

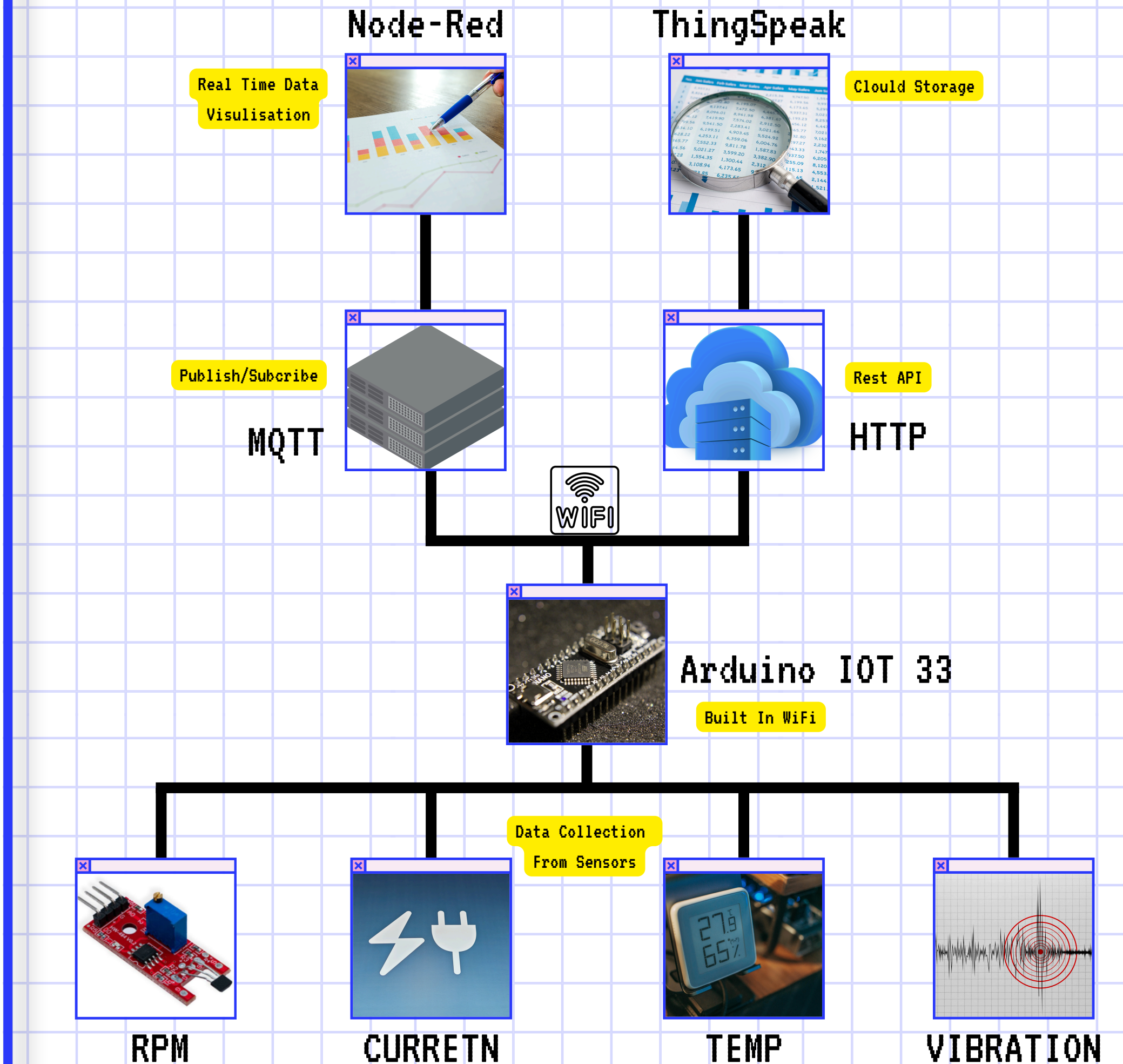
- Built into Nano 33 IoT • Direct internet
- High data rate for multi-sensor real-time streaming
- Industrial plants have WiFi infrastructure

MQTT Chosen Because

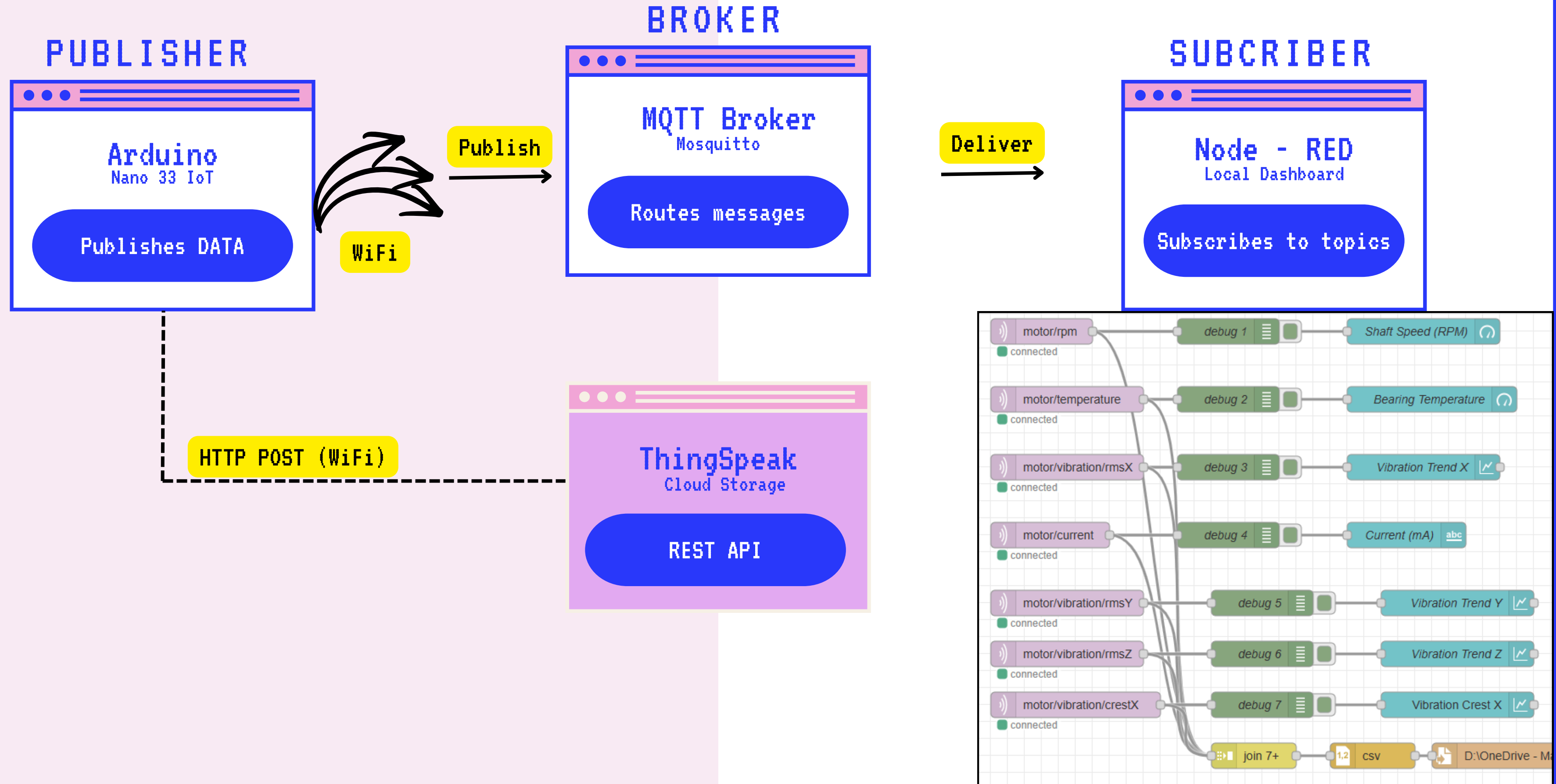
- Publish-subscribe model • Low bandwidth overhead
- Low latency • Scales to multiple devices
- Native Node-RED support

ThingSpeak Chosen Because

- Long-term dataset logging • Remote access
- MATLAB analytics for future ML integration



API & DASHBOARD



COLLECTED DATASETS

Test Conditions

Low Speed - 500 to 600 RPM - Healthy

High Speed - 1030 RPM - Healthy

High Speed - 1030 RPM - Loose Screw

High Speed - 1030 RPM - Shaft Misalignment

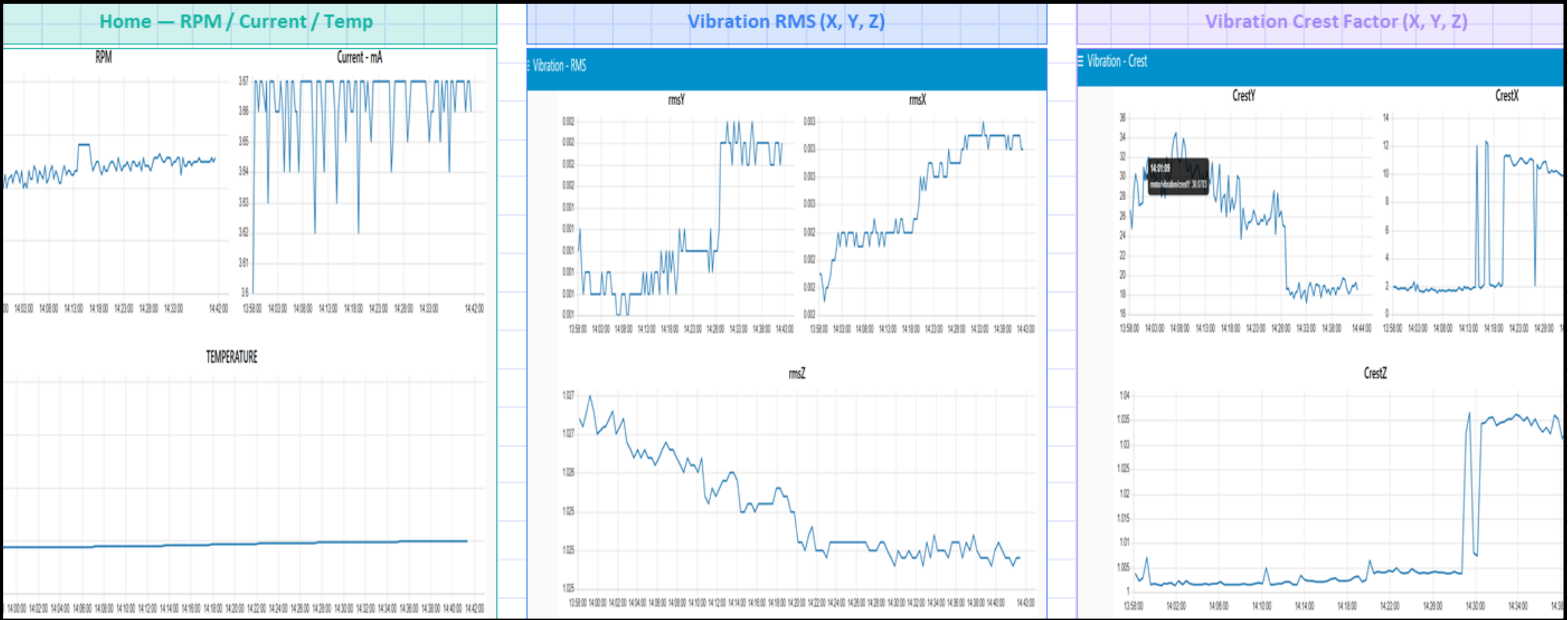
KEY FINDINGS



DATASET – NORMAL OPERATION (~500–600 RPM)

✓ NORMAL

Baseline healthy condition • Temp: 21–24°C • RPM: ~600 • Current: ~3.66A

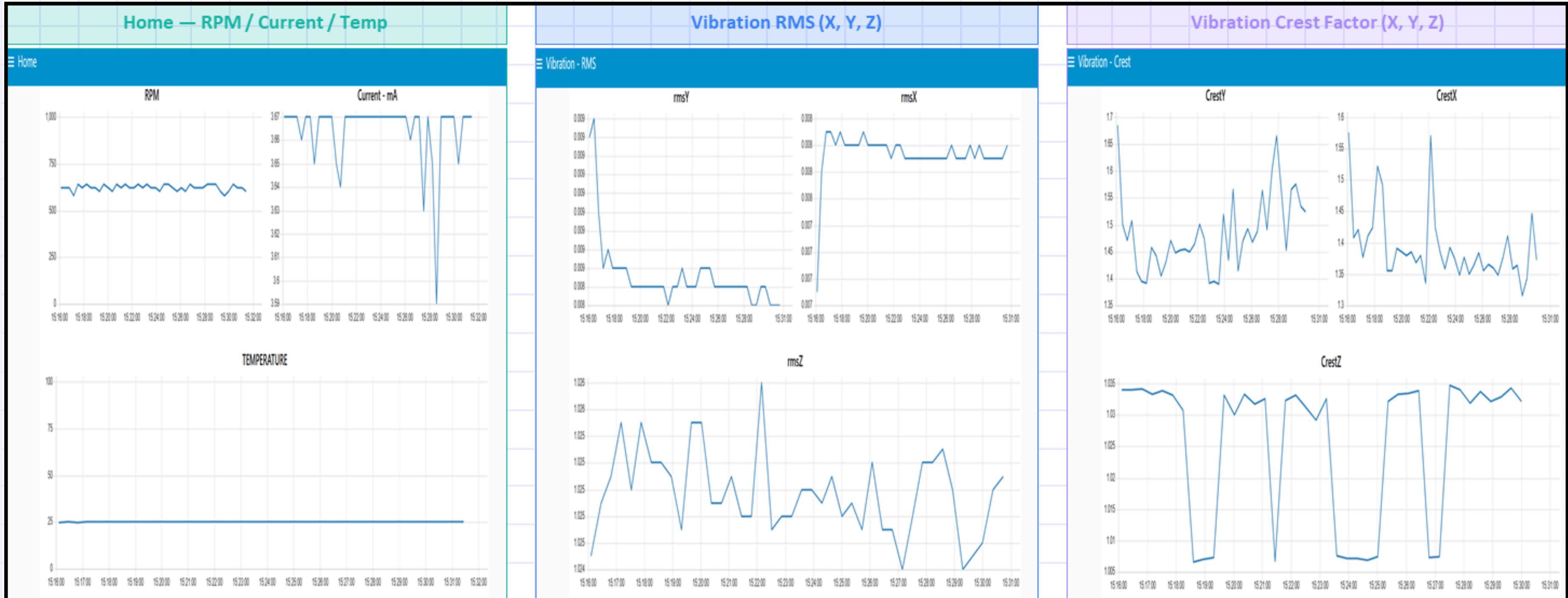


RMS Y is slightly elevated (~0.0085 g) at higher speed - expected and normal. Crest factors are low and stable (~1.4–1.7). RPM stabilises quickly after motor startup. No fault signature present.

DATASET – NO LOOSE SCREW, 1030 RPM

✓ HEALTHY

Healthy condition at higher speed • RPM: ~ 1030 • Current: $\sim 3.67\text{A}$ • Temp: $\sim 25^\circ\text{C}$

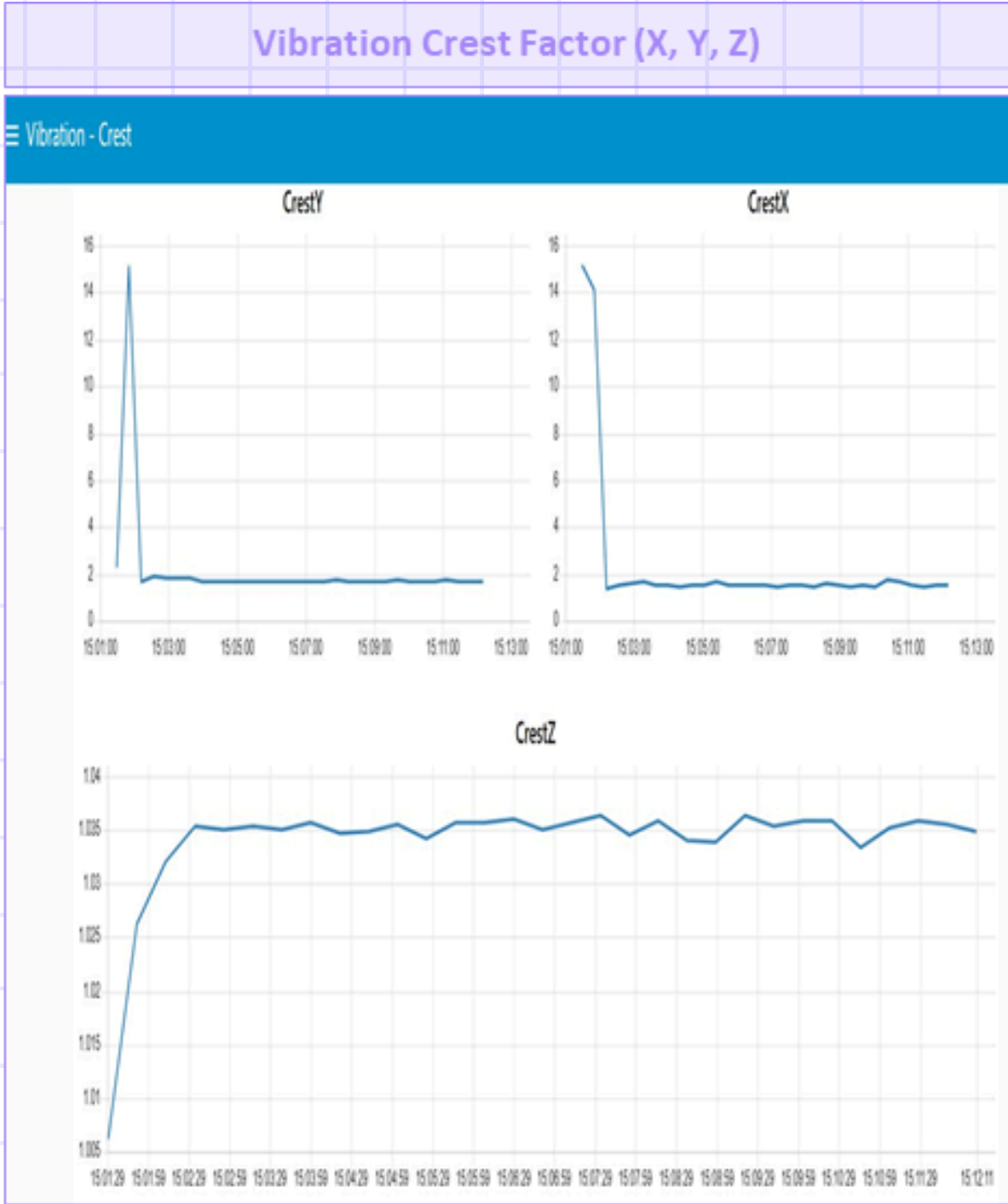
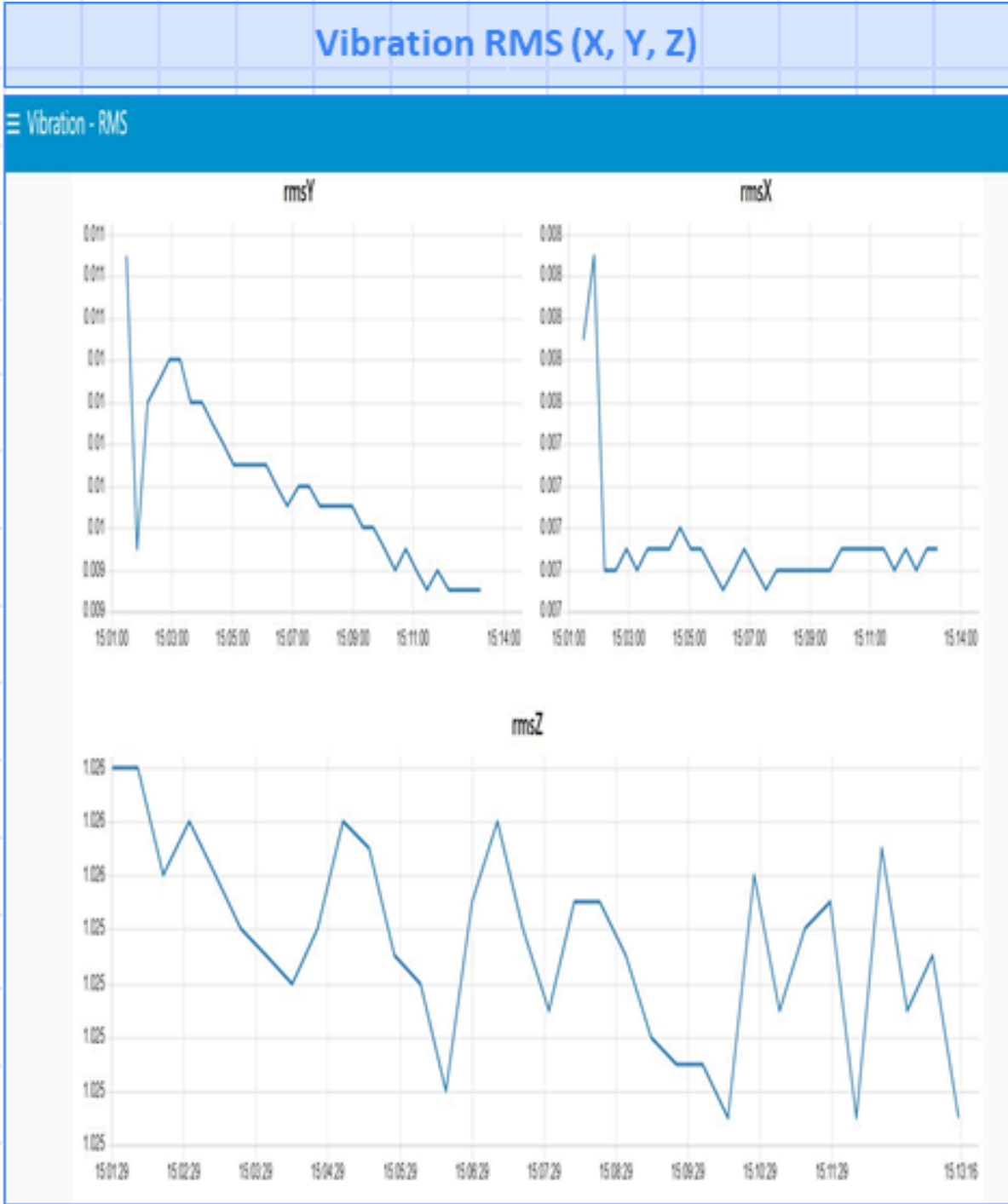
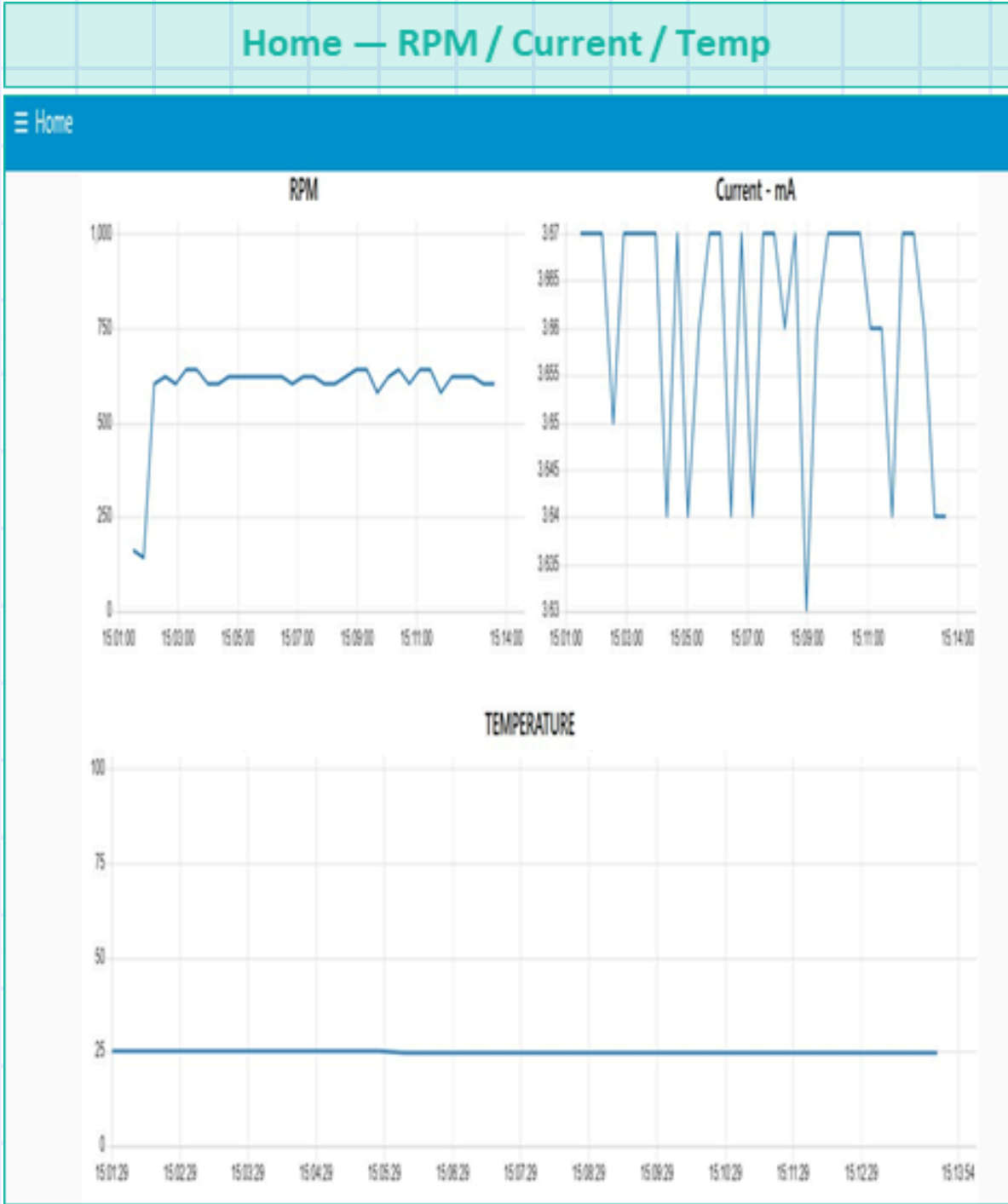


RMS Y is slightly elevated ($\sim 0.0085\text{ g}$) at higher speed – expected and normal. Crest factors are low and stable (~ 1.4 – 1.7). RPM stabilises quickly after motor startup. No fault signature present.

DATASET – LOOSE SCREW FAULT, 1030 RPM

 LOOSE SCREW

Mechanical fault introduced • RPM: ~1030 • Current: ~3.66A • Temp: ~24.9°C

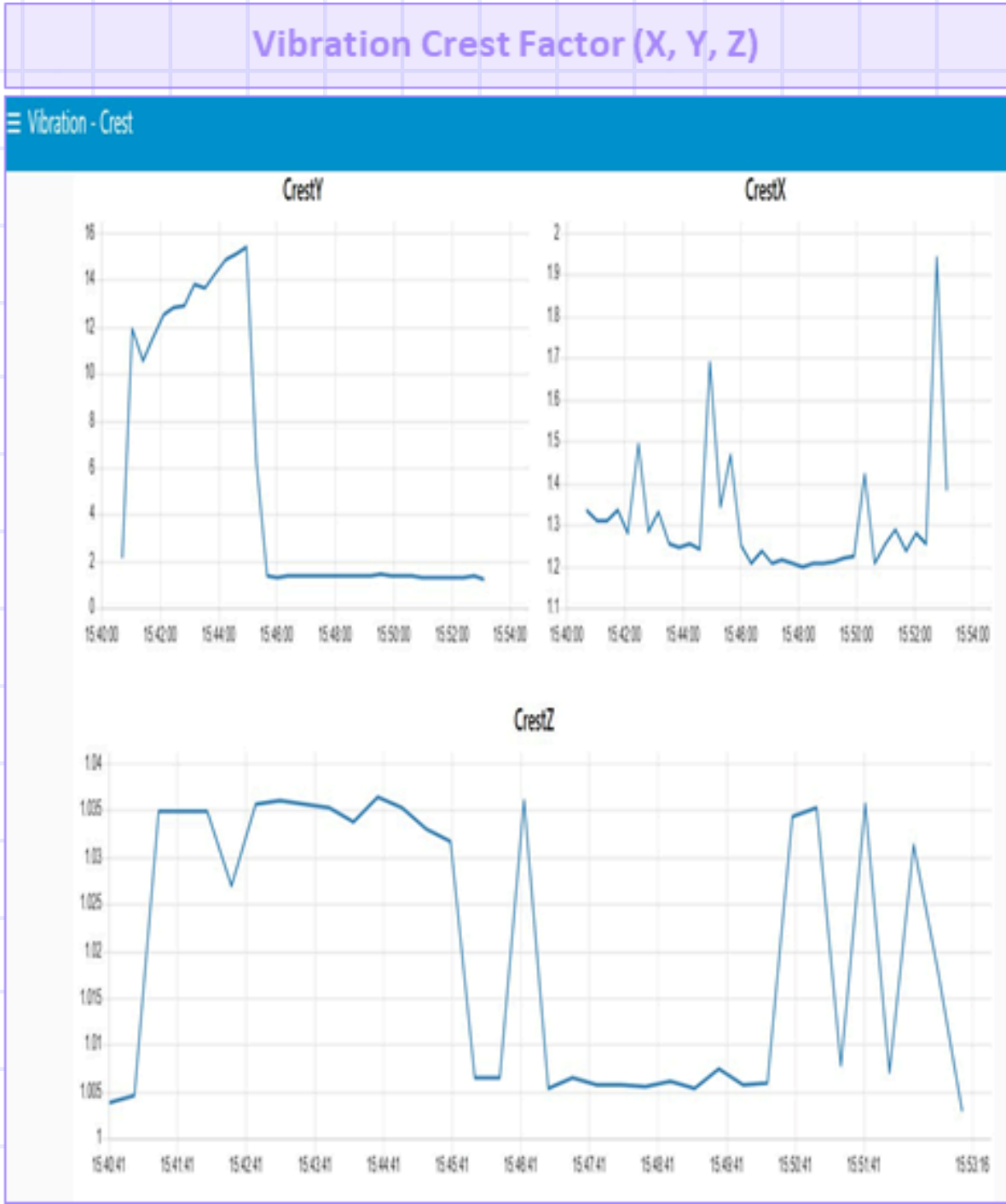
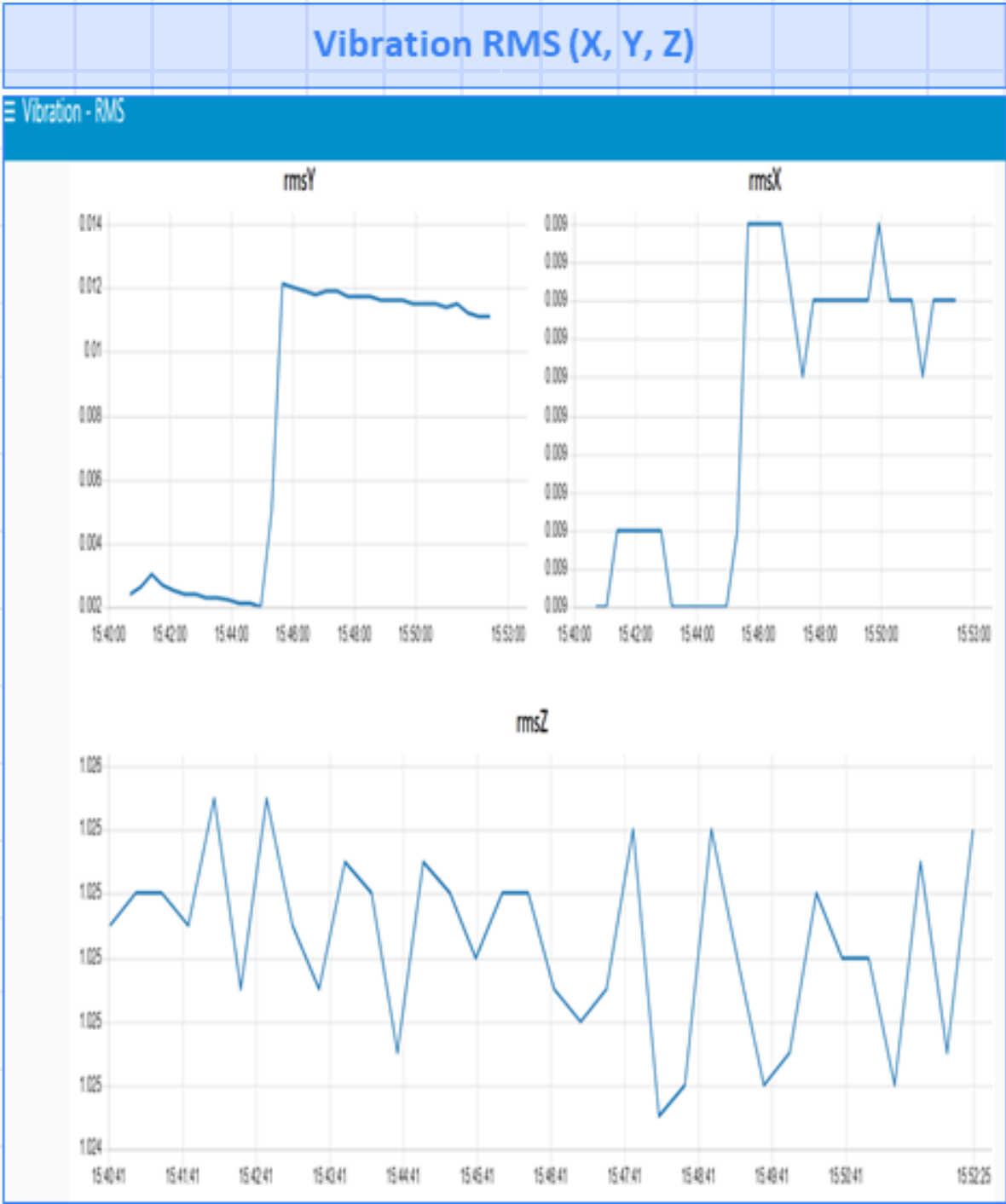
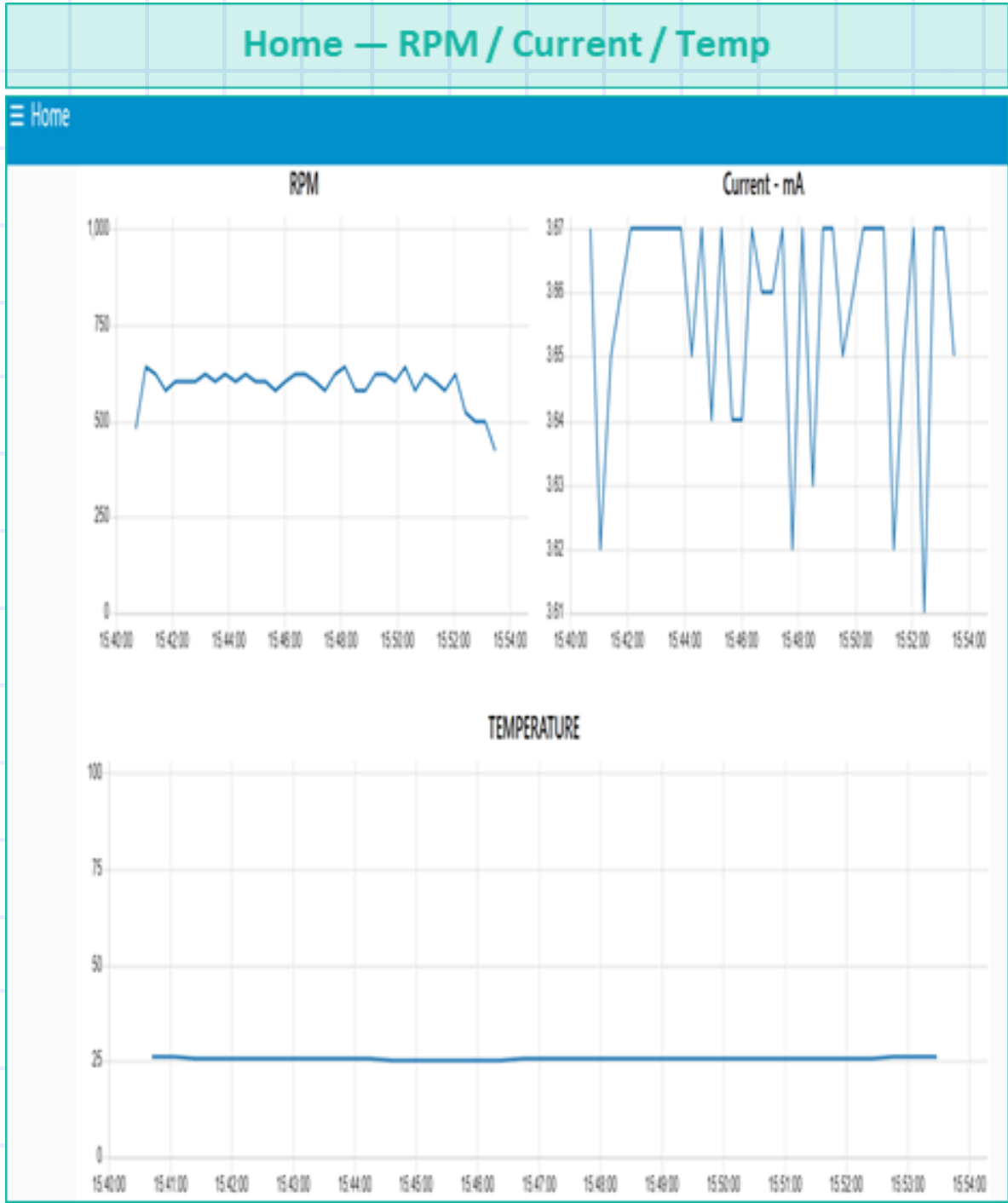


RMS Y clearly elevated (~0.0097-0.010g) – above normal baseline. Vibration settling visible after initial transient. Loose screw introduces periodic mechanical impacts detectable in both RMS and Crest factor.

DATASET – SHAFT MISALIGNMENT, 1030 RPM

X MISALIGNMENT

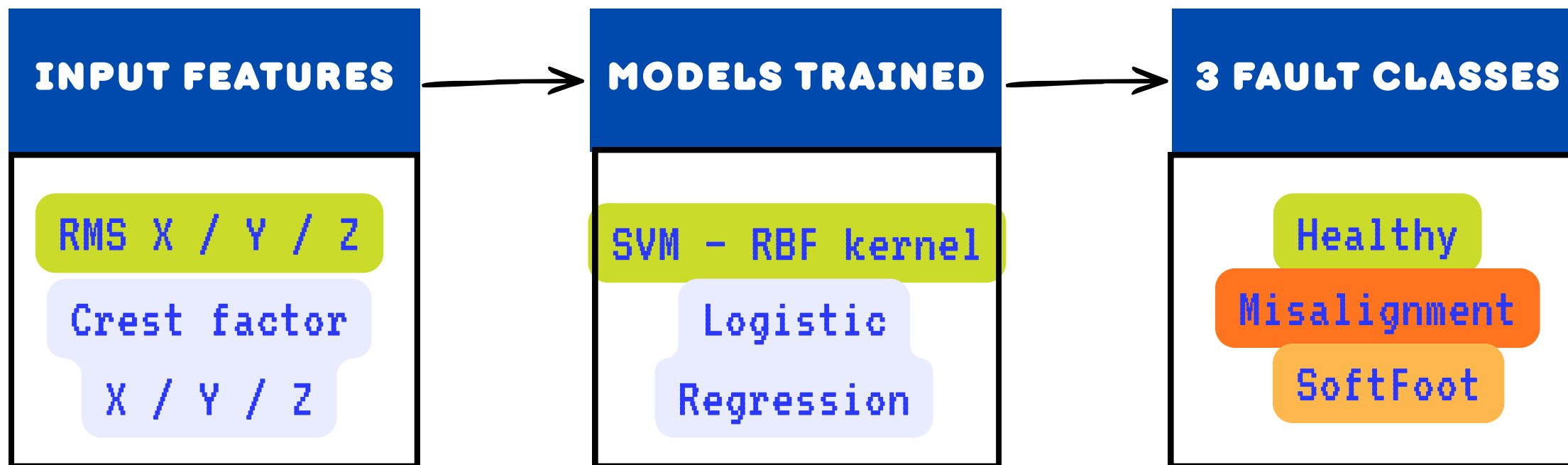
Misalignment fault introduced • RPM: ~1030 • Current: ~3.66A • Temp: ~25.6°C



RMS Y large transient spike (0.076-0.084g) on fault start → settles at elevated ~0.011-0.012g. CrestY peaks >15.

MACHINE LEARNING

TIMELINE



Why only vibration?

Temperature and current showed near-zero variance across fault conditions.

STEP 1

DATA CLEANING

Drop nulls · rename MQTT topics to features
· add labels

STEP 2

MERGE DATASETS

Healthy · Misalignment · SoftFoot →
shuffled CSV

STEP 3

EDA + SPLIT

Boxplots · PCA · correlation · 80/20
stratified split

STEP 4

TRAIN + EVALUATE

SVM (RBF) · Logistic Regression ·
GridSearchCV 5-fold

Feature Patterns by Class

Each vibration feature carries
distinct discriminative information

rms_x

Three classes cleanly
separated

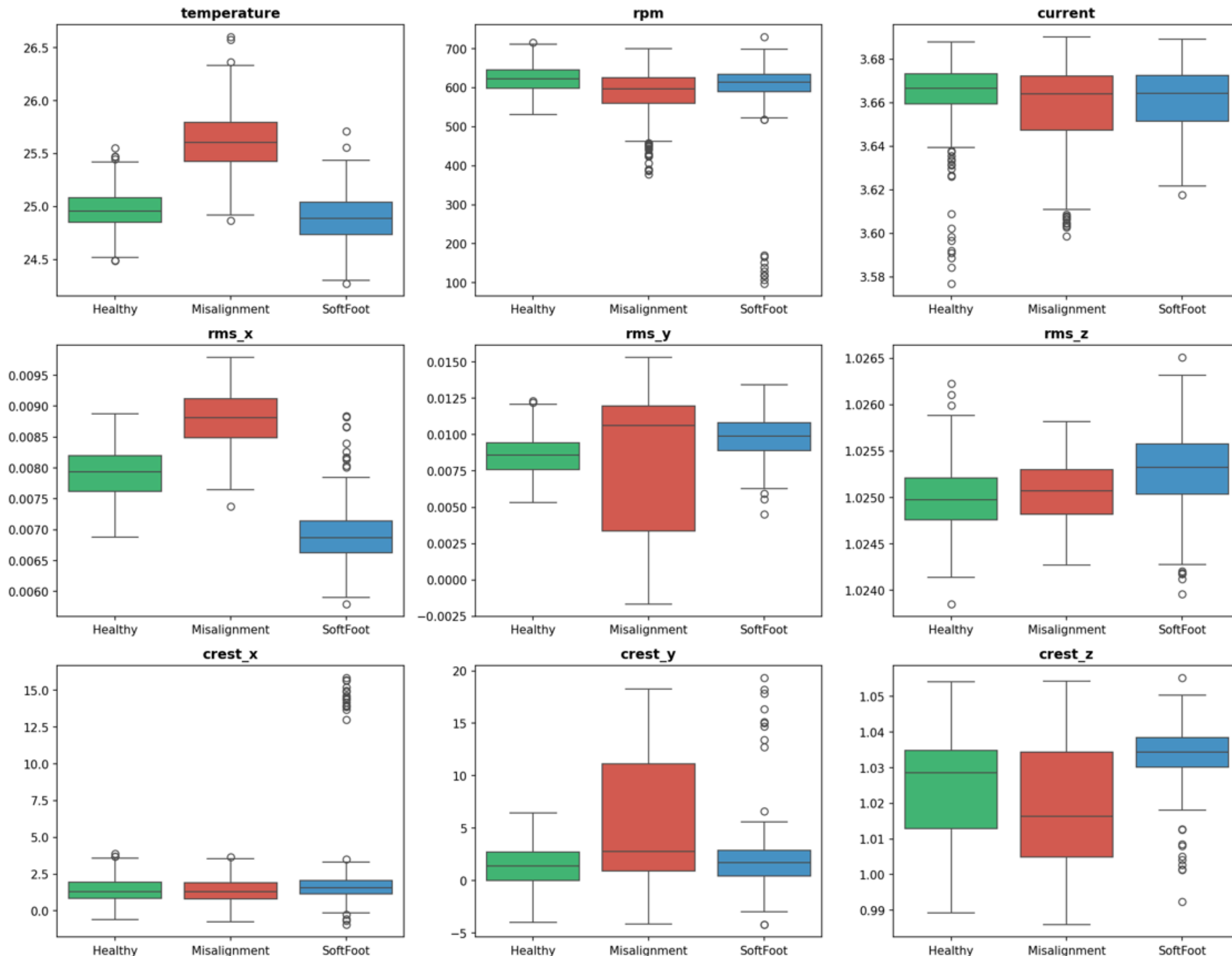
crest_y

Misalignment: huge
spread, values up to 15

crest_x

SoftFoot: extreme
outliers around 14-15

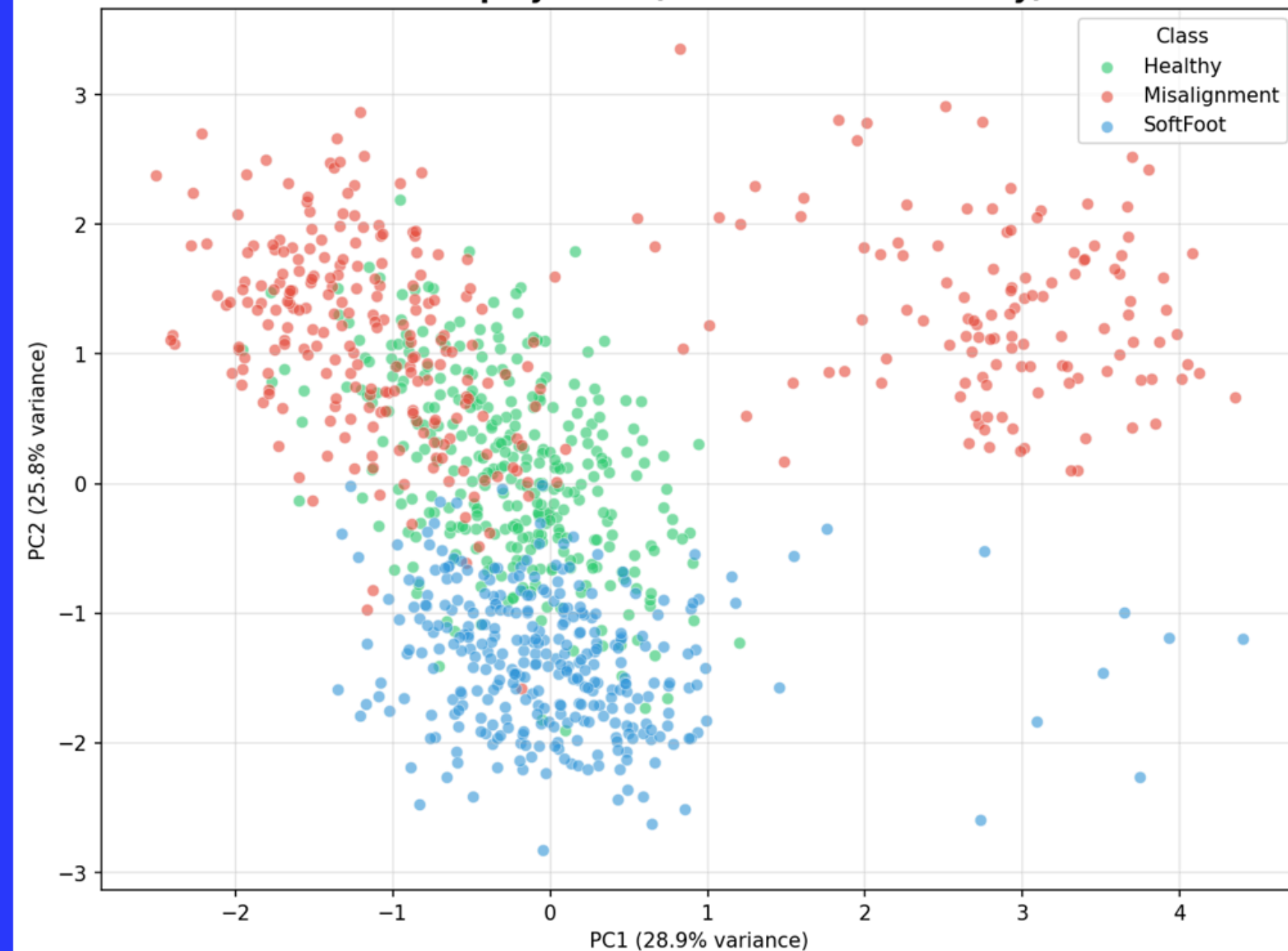
Feature distributions by class (motor_dataset_v2)



CLASS SEPARATION IN 2D

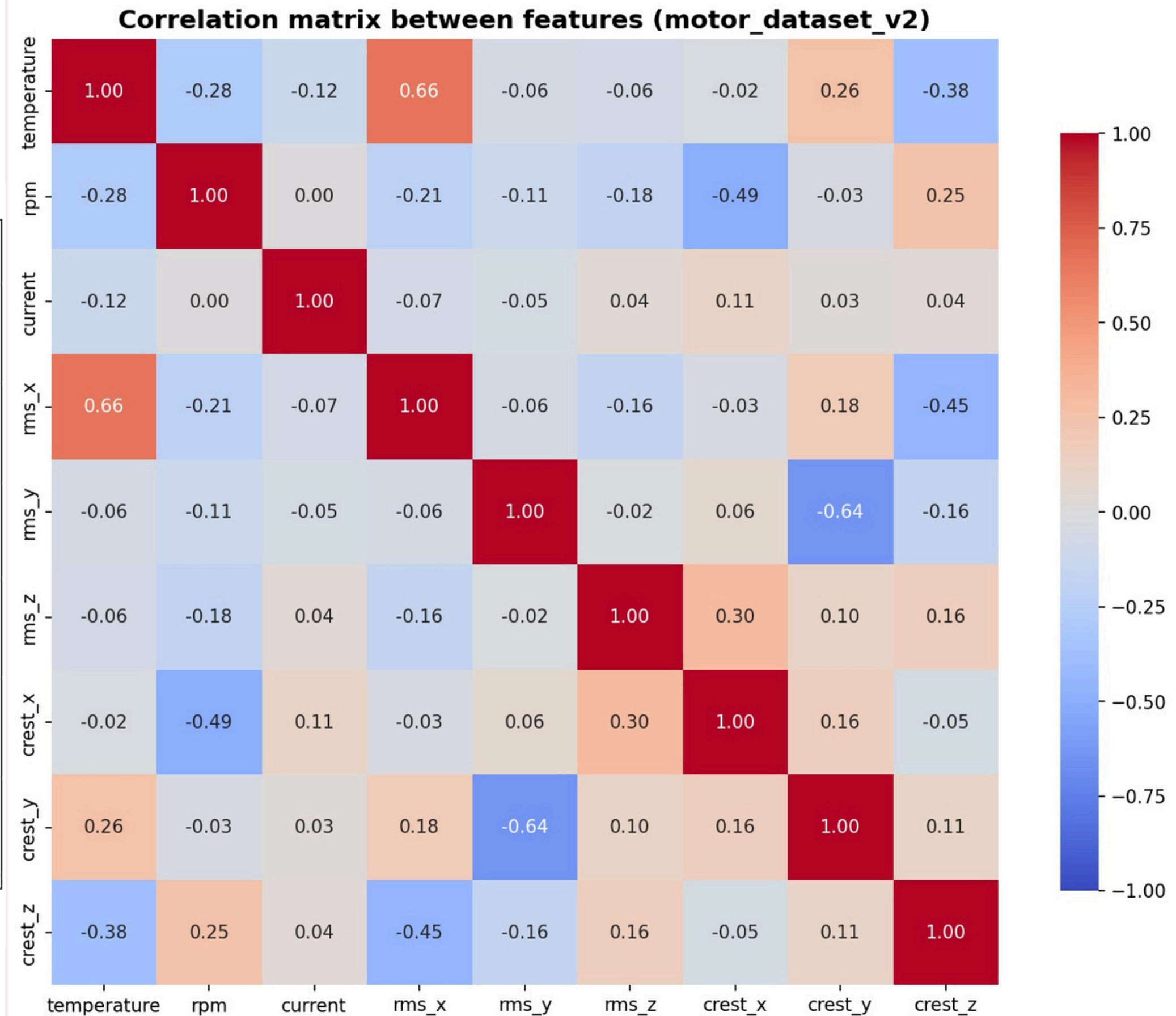
PCA projection of the six standardised vibration features

PCA 2D projection (vibration features only)



PC1 + PC2 explain 54.7% of the variance

CORRELATION MATRIX



CONFUSION MATRIX



Error Analysis

SVM

8 / 10

errors are faults → healthy

(false negatives for fault detection)

SVM (RBF)

95.0%

Test accuracy | Macro F1 = 0.95

Logistic Regression

90.6%

Test accuracy | Macro F1 = 0.91

Error Analysis

Logistic Regression

15 / 19

errors are faults → healthy

(false negatives for fault detection)

ADVANTAGES

- **LOW COST**

Shunt resistor + onboard IMU eliminates two expensive sensor modules entirely

- **NO EXTRA WIRING (IMU)**

LSM6DS3 built into Nano 33 IoT and vibration data gathers with no additional hardware

- **DUAL DASHBOARD**

Local Node-RED + ThingSpeak cloud gives real-time and historical data access

DISADVANTAGES

- **IMU PLACEMENT**

Board on breadboard reduces vibration coupling sensitivity vs direct mounting

- **RPM SENSOR NOISE**

Hall effect RPM sensor was detecting false readings, to overcome that, we used debouncing

- **WIFI DROPOUTS**

Reconnection logic is implemented in the firmware

FUTURE WORK & CONCLUSION

Mount IMU on Motor Housing:

Direct bearing-housing mounting improves vibration coupling by 3-5X

Train ML on more failure modes

Collect data from more fault categories + Use other ML models

Deploy TinyML On-Device

Run the trained model on Nano 33 IoT for real-time edge inference

Extend to AC Motor

Replace shunt with isolated CT sensor

CONCLUSION:

We successfully implemented a 4-sensor IIoT health monitoring system for a DC motor using an Arduino Nano 33 IoT. Real-time data is streamed via WiFi/MQTT to Node-RED and ThingSpeak. Dataset analysis across 5 test conditions demonstrates clear vibration signatures for fault detection - confirming the system's viability for predictive maintenance

THANK YOU